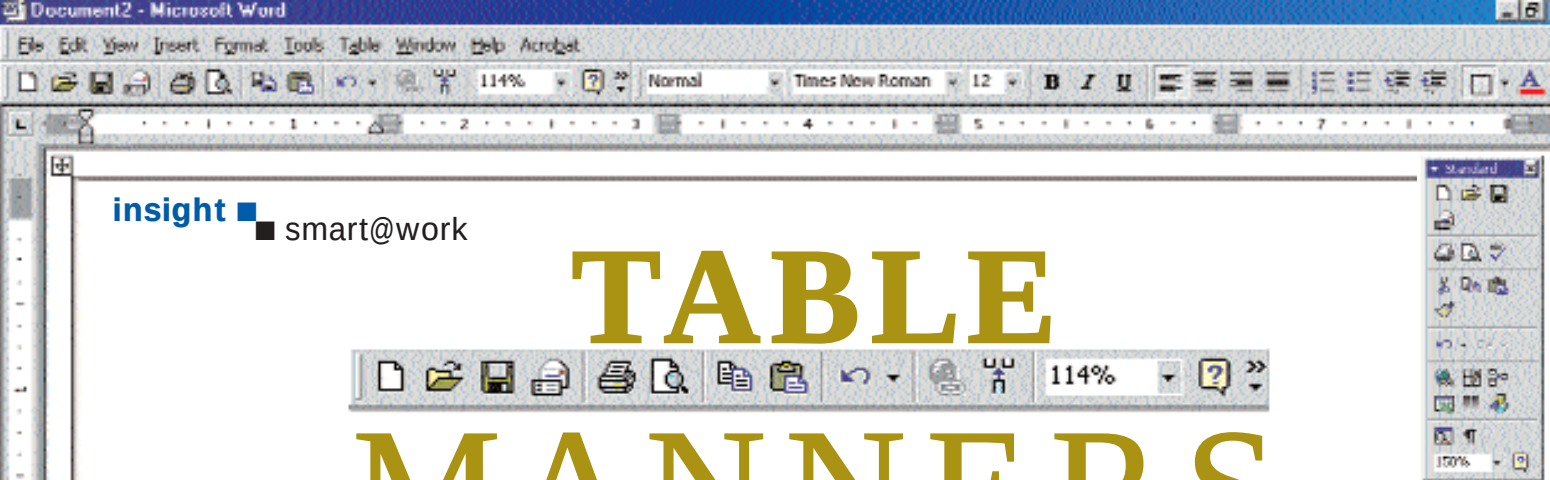




insight ■ smart@work

TABLE MANNERS

Use tables in Word 2000 and XP to improve efficiency and aesthetics

Tables, in Microsoft Word, are powerful tools for organising and formatting while being flexible and easy to use. Here's how to get started with tables, and use them to their maximum capacity. Tables are used to present data in a readable and structured format.

Inserting Tables

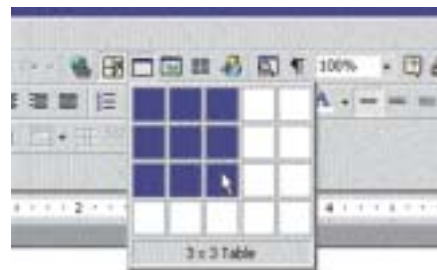
There are many ways to insert tables into documents. The simplest method is to use the namesake tool, Table. Just go to **Table**



From the **Insert Table** box, you can choose the number of rows and columns of your table

> **Insert > Table**, to bring up the Insert Table box. Choose the number of rows and columns you want, click OK, and your table is created.

Another simple method of inserting tables is to click the Insert Table button, move your mouse across the grid that



Using the Insert Table button, you can instantly create a table with the desired number of rows and columns.

pops out, and click when you see the desired number of rows and columns.

Once your table is ready, you can directly enter text into the cells by clicking and typing. For navigation among the cell using the keyboard, see the box Keyboard Shortcuts.

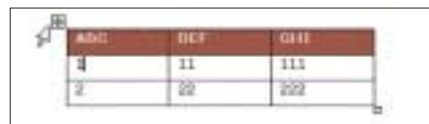
Selecting the cells

Before formatting text or data, you need to select an object. Selection of one or more adjacent cells can easily be achieved by dragging the mouse across the cells. Rows and columns can be selected by this method as well. You can also use the menu option **Table > Select > Table/Column/Row/Cell**, to select whatever you want. However there are certain shortcuts to select entire rows, columns and tables. When you move your mouse pointer on the upper border of the table, the mouse pointer changes to a downward-pointing black arrow. Now when you click, the entire column is selected. The same procedure can be applied for selecting rows as well—instead of moving your cursor to the top, move it to the left.



You can select entire rows or columns with a single click

Selecting the entire table is very easy. When your mouse pointer is anywhere over the table, you will see a small box at



You can select the entire table, by clicking at the top-left corner

the top-left corner. Just click on it and your entire table is selected.

Restructuring and resizing the table

More often than not, you will need to make changes in the number of rows and columns in your table. So let's see how we can do this. To add a row at the end of table, simply press [Tab] when the cursor is at the bottom right cell of the table. To add a column to the right of the last column in a table, click just outside the rightmost column. On the Table menu, point to Insert, and then click 'Columns to the Right'. Similarly, click 'Columns to the Left' to insert columns to the left. To insert rows, click **Table > Insert > Rows Above or Rows Below**, depending on your requirement.

Sometimes, you might need to merge certain cells to be merged into a single cell. This can be achieved by selecting the cells you want to merge, and going to **Table >**

Let your Data Breathe

White space is an important design element, whether you're designing Web pages, documents, brochures, or tables. In a table, giving the data room to breathe makes the table more appealing.

To adjust the space in your table, select the entire table. In the Format menu click Paragraph. The Paragraph dialog box will appear. You can then add consistent spacing to give some cushion between the text and the cell boundaries. To do this, under Spacing, in the Before box, type '4 pt.'

And your readers are likely to stick around long enough to understand what you are trying to show them.